KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

Instructions for the Woman of the House

Every instruction in Scripture that falls on a married mother

A Kingdom Life Teaching Handout for wives and mothers, the companion to Instructions for the Man of the House

Scripture quoted from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai, with Yahshua and Messiah restored. Torah is referred to throughout as the instructions of YHWH.

THE HEART OF IT

Women are often told what Scripture says to them in a single verse or two, usually about submission, and then nothing else. But a woman stands in the covenant in her own right. When Moses gathered the people to hear the instructions, he named the women by name.

This handout gathers every instruction that falls on a married woman with children who does not farm or keep livestock. All 108 are numbered and given with their references, so you can open your Bible and check every one.

> *Assemble the people, the men and the women and the little ones, and the foreigners who are within your gates, that they may hear, and that they may learn, and fear YHWH your Elohim...*
> **DEUTERONOMY 31:12**

SECTION I

How to Read This Handout

Scripture never hands us a numbered list. The famous count of 613 commandments comes from the rabbis (Talmud, Makkot 23b), not from the text itself, and rabbinic tradition goes on to excuse women from many of them. We set both aside. Every instruction below is tied to the verse it comes from, and where Scripture stops speaking, an interpretation is not called a commandment.

Most of what YHWH commands is spoken to his whole people, men and women together. The pages that follow include all of those, plus the instructions spoken to wives, mothers and women in particular. The instructions spoken only to men are listed at the end so you can see what was left out and why.

The Labels You Will See

- **No label.** A plain instruction that applies to you today.
- **PRINCIPLE**: the letter was given in a setting you may not be in, but the principle carries straight into your life.
- **SITUATIONAL**: applies only when that situation comes up.
- **WISDOM**: from Proverbs. True and binding on the conscience, but written as wisdom rather than as a Torah commandment.

- **DEBATED**: believers who keep the instructions read this one differently. The note tells you why.

> **NOT A LADDER TO HEAVEN**
>
> None of this is how a woman earns salvation. Yahshua paid for that with his own blood. These are the instructions of a Father to a daughter who already belongs to him. **We do not obey to be accepted. We obey because we have been.**

SECTION II

Toward YHWH

The greatest commandment has no gender. A woman's first calling is not to her husband or her children. It is to YHWH himself.

> *Hear, Israel: YHWH is our Elohim. YHWH is one. You shall love YHWH your Elohim with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your might.*
> **DEUTERONOMY 6:4-5**

1. Love YHWH with all your heart, soul and strength. **Deut 6:4-5; Matt 22:37**
2. Fear him, serve him, cling to him, and swear only by his name. **Deut 6:13; 10:20**
3. Have no other gods, and make no idols to bow down to. **Ex 20:3-6**
4. Do not take his name in vain. **Ex 20:7**
5. Do not speak the names of other gods. **Ex 23:13**
6. Do not ask how the nations served their gods so you can worship YHWH the same way. **Deut 12:30-31**
7. Keep idol objects out of your house. **Deut 7:25-26**
8. Do not add to his instructions or take away from them. **Deut 4:2; 12:32**
9. Test every prophet, and reject anyone who leads you toward other gods. **Deut 13:1-5; 18:15-22**
10. No divination, sorcery, omens, mediums or spiritists. **Lev 19:26, 31; 20:6; Deut 18:10-12**
11. Bless YHWH after you eat and are satisfied. **Deut 8:10**

SECTION III

The Sabbath and the Appointed Times

The Sabbath commandment names the son and the daughter, the male servant and the female servant. The feasts name the daughter and the widow. A woman is not a spectator at YHWH's appointed times.

> *You shall rejoice in your feast, you, your son, your daughter, your male servant, your female servant, the Levite, the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow, who are within your gates.*
> **DEUTERONOMY 16:14**

12. Keep the seventh day holy. Do no work, and do not make your children, your workers or the stranger with you work. **Ex 20:8-11; Deut 5:12-15**
13. Do not buy or sell on the Sabbath. **Neh 10:31; 13:15-22; Isa 58:13; Amos 8:5**
14. Keep the appointed times of YHWH. **Lev 23**
15. Passover and Unleavened Bread: put the leaven out of your house and eat unleavened bread. **Ex 12:15-20**
16. Yom Kippur: afflict your soul and do no work. **Lev 23:27-32**
17. Sukkot: dwell in booths, take the branches, and rejoice before YHWH. **Lev 23:40-42; Deut 16:14**
18. Gather with the men and the children to hear the instructions read at Sukkot in the seventh year. **Deut 31:10-13** SITUATIONAL

> **SHE WENT UP TOO**
>
> Only the males were required to appear three times a year (**Deuteronomy 16:16**), yet women went freely. Hannah went up year by year to Shiloh (**1 Samuel 1:3-7**), and Mary went to Jerusalem every year at Passover (**Luke 2:41**). **Not required never meant not welcome.**

SECTION IV

As a Wife

Ezer Kenegdo: A Helper Corresponding to Him

In Genesis 2:18 YHWH says he will make the man *ezer kenegdo*, a helper suitable for him, one who corresponds to him. The word *ezer* is not a word for a servant. Scripture uses it most often for YHWH himself, the help of his people (**Psalm 33:20; 121:1-2**). The wife is the help without whom the man was not good.

Submission in Context

In the Greek of Ephesians 5:22 there is no verb. The verb is borrowed from verse 21: *hupotasso*, subjecting yourselves to one another in the fear of Messiah. A wife's submission sits inside a whole household that is yielding to each other, and right beside a husband who is told to lay his life down for her. Submission is never a command to obey sin, and it is never permission for abuse.

> *Nevertheless each of you must also love his own wife even as himself; and let the wife see that she respects her husband.*
> **EPHESIANS 5:33**

19. Submit to your own husband as to Adonai. **Eph 5:22-24; Col 3:18; Titus 2:5**
20. Respect your husband. **Eph 5:33**
21. Love your husband. **Titus 2:4**
22. If your husband does not obey the Word, win him by your conduct, without a word. **1 Pet 3:1-2** SITUATIONAL
23. Let your beauty be the hidden person of the heart, a gentle and quiet spirit. **1 Pet 3:3-4**

24. Give your husband what you owe him in marriage. Do not deprive each other, except by agreement for a season of prayer. **1 Cor 7:3-5**

25. Do not leave your husband. If you do separate, remain unmarried or be reconciled. **1 Cor 7:10-11** SITUATIONAL
Read alongside the release Paul allows when an unbelieving spouse departs (1 Cor 7:15) and Yahshua's exception (Matt 19:9).

26. If your husband is an unbeliever who is content to stay, do not leave him. **1 Cor 7:13-14** SITUATIONAL

27. Your husband confirms or cancels your vows on the day he hears them. As a widow or a divorced woman, your vows stand on their own. **Num 30:6-15; 30:9**

28. Keep the days of your monthly separation, and no relations during that time. **Lev 15:19-24; 18:19; 20:18**

29. After childbirth, keep the days of purification. **Lev 12:1-8** DEBATED
The days are written plainly. The offering that closed them required a priest, and believers differ on how the days are kept without one.

30. Keep the marriage bed undefiled. **Heb 13:4**

31. Be sober minded, chaste and kind. **Titus 2:5**

32. Do your husband good and not harm, all the days of your life. **Prov 31:12** WISDOM

33. Do not be a contentious wife. **Prov 21:9, 19; 25:24** WISDOM

34. If you were divorced and married another man, do not return to the first husband. **Deut 24:1-4** SITUATIONAL

> *Let your beauty be not just the outward adorning of braiding the hair, and of wearing jewels of gold, or of putting on fine clothing; but in the hidden person of the heart, in the incorruptible adornment of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of Elohim very precious.*
> **1 PETER 3:3-4**

SECTION V

As a Mother

Proverbs calls a mother's teaching her *torah*, the same word used for the instructions of YHWH. Timothy's faith lived first in his grandmother Lois and his mother Eunice before Paul ever met him (**2 Timothy 1:5**). A mother is not an assistant teacher in the home. She is one of its two teachers.

> *My son, listen to your father's instruction, and don't forsake your mother's teaching:*
> **PROVERBS 1:8**

35. Teach your children the instructions diligently, at home, on the road, lying down and rising up. **Deut 6:7; 11:19**

36. Give your children teaching worth keeping, and keep the teaching of kindness on your tongue. **Prov 1:8; 6:20; 31:26** WISDOM

37. Love your children. **Titus 2:4**

38. Pass your faith on to your children, as Lois and Eunice did. **2 Tim 1:5; 3:15** PRINCIPLE

39. Manage your household well, and give the enemy no occasion to speak against you. **1 Tim 5:14** **PRINCIPLE**
    Written to younger widows who remarry. The calling to rule the house well carries to every wife and mother.

40. Be a worker at home. **Titus 2:5** **DEBATED**
    The Greek is oikourgos (some manuscripts read oikouros, keeper at home). Believers differ on what it rules in or out. The woman of Proverbs 31 also buys a field and sells goods (Prov 31:16, 24).

41. Watch over the ways of your household, and do not eat the bread of idleness. **Prov 31:15, 27** **WISDOM**

42. Correct your children. A child left to himself brings shame to his mother. **Prov 29:15** **WISDOM**

43. Never give a child to Molech or pass one through the fire. **Lev 18:21**

> *Every wise woman builds her house, but the foolish one tears it down with her own hands.*
> **PROVERBS 14:1**

SECTION VI

As a Daughter

A mother never stops being a daughter, and your children are watching how you keep this one.

44. Honor your father and your mother. **Ex 20:12**

45. Revere your mother and your father. **Lev 19:3**

46. Do not curse your father or mother. **Ex 21:17**

SECTION VII

Sexual Purity

47. Do not commit adultery, including adultery of the heart. **Ex 20:14; Matt 5:27-28**

48. Keep the forbidden relations of Leviticus 18 and 20. **Lev 18; 20**

49. Flee sexual immorality. **1 Cor 6:18; Acts 15:20**

SECTION VIII

Food

> *For you are a holy people to YHWH your Elohim, and YHWH has chosen you to be a people for his own possession, above all peoples who are on the face of the earth.*
> **DEUTERONOMY 14:2**

In most homes the one who plans the table guards these instructions for the whole family. They are obedience first. Health benefits are real, but they are not the reason.

50. Eat only the clean animals. **Lev 11; Deut 14:3-20**

51. Do not eat blood. **Lev 17:10-14; Deut 12:16, 23; Acts 15:20**

52. Do not eat the fat of the ox, the sheep or the goat. **Lev 3:17; 7:23-25**

53. Do not eat what died of itself or was torn by beasts. **Lev 17:15; Deut 14:21**

54. Do not boil a young goat in its mother's milk. **Ex 23:19; Deut 14:21** DEBATED
    Rabbinic tradition turned this into the full separation of meat and dairy. The text itself names a kid and its own mother's milk.

55. Do not get drunk with wine. **Eph 5:18; Titus 2:3**

SECTION IX

Appearance and Dress

> *In the same way, that women also adorn themselves in decent clothing, with modesty and propriety; not just with braided hair, gold, pearls, or expensive clothing; but (which becomes women professing godliness) with good works.*
> **1 TIMOTHY 2:9-10**

56. Dress with modesty and propriety, and let good works be your adornment. **1 Tim 2:9-10; 1 Pet 3:3-4**

57. Do not wear what pertains to a man. **Deut 22:5**

58. No cuttings in your flesh for the dead, and no tattoos. **Lev 19:28**

59. Do not wear wool and linen woven together. **Lev 19:19; Deut 22:11**

60. Write his words on the doorposts of your house and on your gates. **Deut 6:9; 11:20**

61. Bind them as a sign on your hand and between your eyes. **Deut 6:8** DEBATED
    Some keep this literally. Others read it as what you do (the hand) and how you think (the eyes), as in Proverbs 3:3 and 7:3.

62. Wear tzitzit on the four corners of your garment, with a cord of blue. **Num 15:37-41; Deut 22:12** DEBATED
    Spoken to the children of Israel. Believers differ on whether that includes women.

63. Cover your head when you pray or prophesy. **1 Cor 11:5-6, 13** DEBATED
    Some keep this as a standing instruction. Others read it as tied to the customs of Corinth.

64. Long hair is a woman's glory, given to her for a covering. **1 Cor 11:15** DEBATED

SECTION X

In the Assembly

A woman has a real teaching calling. She teaches her children, and the older women teach the younger women (**Titus 2:3-5; 2 Timothy 1:5**). But when the assembly gathers, Paul gives a clear order: the men carry the teaching and the discussion, and a wife brings her questions and objections to her husband at home. That is not a muzzle on her voice. It is YHWH's order for his house, and the same order runs from the home into the assembly.

> *and that older women likewise be reverent in behavior, not slanderers nor enslaved to much wine, teachers of that which is good; that they may train the young wives to love their husbands, to love their children, to be sober minded, chaste, workers at home, kind, being in subjection to their own husbands, that Elohim's word may not be blasphemed.*
> **TITUS 2:3-5**

65. As an older woman, be reverent, no slanderer, not enslaved to wine, and a teacher of what is good. **Titus 2:3** SITUATIONAL

66. As an older woman, train the younger women. **Titus 2:4-5** SITUATIONAL

67. If you serve the assembly, be dignified, not a slanderer, sober and faithful in all things. **1 Tim 3:11** SITUATIONAL

68. Care for the widows in your own family so the assembly is not burdened. **1 Tim 5:16**

69. Learn in quietness. Do not teach the assembly or take authority over a man. **1 Tim 2:11-12**
    Paul grounds this in creation order, Adam formed first (1 Tim 2:13), not in a local custom. Her teaching place is with children and with other women (Titus 2:3-5; 2 Tim 1:5).

70. In the assembly, let the men do the teaching and the discussing. Do not interrupt or publicly object. If you want to learn something or disagree, ask your husband at home. **1 Cor 14:34-35**
    Talking among the women is not what is in view. Public teaching, discussing and objecting in the meeting is. Even Priscilla's teaching of Apollos was done privately, alongside her husband (Acts 18:26).

SECTION XI

Work, Money and Business

The woman of Proverbs 31 considers a field and buys it, makes linen garments and sells them, and opens her hand to the poor (**Proverbs 31:16, 20, 24**). Whatever business a woman does, these instructions go with her.

71. Work six days. **Ex 20:9; 2 Thess 3:10**

72. Use honest weights and measures, and deal honestly in every sale. **Lev 19:35-36; Deut 25:13-16**

73. Pay your workers on time, and do not oppress them. **Lev 19:13; Deut 24:14-15**

74. Charge no interest to a brother or sister in need. **Ex 22:25; Lev 25:35-37; Deut 23:19-20**

75. Return a poor person's pledge by sundown. Never take a millstone as a pledge, or a widow's garment. **Ex 22:26-27; Deut 24:6, 10-13, 17**

76. Open your hand wide to the poor. **Deut 15:7-11; Prov 31:20**

77. Release debts in the seventh year. **Deut 15:1-2** DEBATED
    This is about lending, not farming. Believers differ on whether and how it is kept today.

78. Do not steal or deal falsely. Repay what you took, and add a fifth. **Ex 20:15; Lev 6:1-5; 19:11**

79. Return lost property to its owner. **Deut 22:1-3**

80. Keep your home safe for those who come into it. **Deut 22:8** PRINCIPLE
    The letter is a railing on a flat roof, where people lived and gathered.

81. Pay your taxes, and give honor to whom honor is due. **Matt 22:21; Rom 13:7**

82. Give generously and in secret. **Matt 6:1-4; 2 Cor 9:7**

SECTION XII

Toward Your Neighbor

> *You shall not take vengeance, nor bear any grudge against the children of your people; but you shall love your neighbor as yourself. I am YHWH.*
> **LEVITICUS 19:18**

83. Do not murder, and do not hate your brother or sister in your heart. **Ex 20:13; Lev 19:17; Matt 5:21-22**
84. No false witness, no gossip, no slander. **Ex 20:16; Lev 19:16; Titus 2:3**
85. Rebuke your neighbor rather than carry sin against them. **Lev 19:17**
86. No vengeance and no grudges. Love your neighbor as yourself. **Lev 19:18**
87. Love the stranger. **Lev 19:33-34; Deut 10:19**
88. Do not curse the deaf or put a stumbling block before the blind. **Lev 19:14**
89. Rise up before the gray head and honor the aged. **Lev 19:32**
90. Do not oppress the widow or the fatherless. **Ex 22:22; James 1:27**
91. Judge fairly. Take no bribe. Do not follow a crowd into evil. **Lev 19:15; Ex 23:1-8**
92. Keep your vows. Let your yes be yes and your no be no. **Deut 23:21-23; Matt 5:33-37**
93. Do not curse a ruler of your people. **Ex 22:28**
94. Pray for kings and all who are in authority. **1 Tim 2:1-2**

SECTION XIII

From Yahshua and the Apostles

Women were the last at the stake and the first at the empty tomb (**Mark 15:40; 16:1-6**). Every word Yahshua spoke to his disciples, he spoke to his daughters too.

> *For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you don't forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.*
> **MATTHEW 6:14-15**

95. Repent and be immersed. **Acts 2:38**
96. Forgive, or you will not be forgiven. **Matt 6:14-15; 18:21-35; Mark 11:25**
97. Be reconciled before you bring your gift. **Matt 5:23-24**
98. Love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you. **Matt 5:44**
99. Love one another as he loved you. **John 13:34**
100. Make disciples. **Matt 28:19-20**
101. Remember him in the bread and the cup. **1 Cor 11:23-26**

102. Do not forsake assembling together. **Heb 10:25**
103. Pray without ceasing. **1 Thess 5:17**
104. Humble yourself. **1 Pet 5:5-6; James 4:6**
105. Put away anger, bitterness and corrupt speech. **Eph 4:26, 29, 31**
106. Do not be unequally yoked with unbelievers. **2 Cor 6:14**
107. Show hospitality. **Heb 13:2; 1 Pet 4:9**
108. When you are sick, call the elders to pray over you. **James 5:14**

> *Charm is deceitful, and beauty is vain; but a woman who fears YHWH, she shall be praised.*
> **PROVERBS 31:30**

THE ORDER OF THINGS

Humility is the root of forgiveness, and forgiveness is the root of deliverance. A woman can keep every line in this handout on the outside and still be bound on the inside. Start with the heart, and the rest follows.

SECTION XIV

What Does Not Fall on You, and Why

Leaving these out does not mean they were abolished. It means they were given to someone else, or they need something that is not in place today.

- **Instructions spoken to men:** appearing three times a year (Deut 16:16), the corners of the beard (Lev 19:27), circumcision (Gen 17:10-12), the emission law (Lev 15:16-18), the husband's and father's role over vows (Num 30), redeeming the firstborn son (Ex 13:13), a man praying with his head uncovered (1 Cor 11:4), and the office of elder (1 Tim 3:1-7).
- **Sacrifices, priesthood, Levites and Temple service**, including the red heifer, the leprosy inspections and the jealousy offering. Each one requires a priest or the Temple. (Lev 1 to 7; 13 to 14; 21 to 22; Num 5; 19)
- **The Nazirite vow.** A woman could take it (Num 6:2), but it only applies if she chooses to.
- **Kings, courts and punishments.** These were given to the government of Israel. (Deut 17)
- **Farming instructions:** the sabbatical and jubilee land rest, gleaning, firstfruits of produce, mixed seed, and the tithe of crops and herds. (Lev 19:9-10; 25; 27:30-32)
- **Livestock instructions:** firstborn animals, mixed breeding, and not muzzling the ox. (Deut 25:4)

> **A NOTE ON THE TITHE**
>
> The Torah tithe was taken from crops and herds, so a household with neither has no Torah tithe of its own. Still, look at how YHWH told it to be used. It could be turned into money and spent rejoicing before him at the feast (**Deuteronomy 14:22-26**), and every third year it went to the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless and the widow (**Deuteronomy 14:28-29**). Giving the first part of your increase for the feasts and the poor walks right in that pattern.

SECTION XV

Walking It Out This Week

- **Pick one section.** Read it with your husband and ask him where you are strong and where you are not.
- **Gather your children once this week** and teach them one instruction and why YHWH gave it.
- **Make one thing right.** Forgive one specific thing, and ask forgiveness for one specific thing.
- **Find a younger woman** to encourage, or an older woman to learn from (Titus 2:3-5).
- **Write down** any instruction you have never walked in, and pray over it before you change anything.

SECTION XVI

Cross Reference Index

Framework: John 14:15; Deuteronomy 4:2; 29:10-12; 30:11; 31:12; Matthew 5:17; 22:37-40

Toward YHWH: Exodus 20:3-7; 23:13; Leviticus 19:26, 31; 20:6; Deuteronomy 6:4-5, 13; 7:25-26; 8:10; 10:20; 12:30-32; 13:1-5; 18:10-22

Sabbath and appointed times: Exodus 12:15-20; 20:8-11; Leviticus 23; Deuteronomy 5:12-15; 16:14-16; 31:10-13; Nehemiah 10:31; 13:15-22; Isaiah 58:13; Amos 8:5; 1 Samuel 1:3-7; Luke 2:41

Wife: Genesis 2:18; Psalm 33:20; 121:1-2; Leviticus 12:1-8; 15:19-24; 18:19; 20:18; Numbers 30:6-15; Deuteronomy 24:1-4; Proverbs 21:9, 19; 25:24; 31:12; Matthew 19:9; 1 Corinthians 7:3-5, 10-15; Ephesians 5:21-33; Colossians 3:18; Titus 2:4-5; Hebrews 13:4; 1 Peter 3:1-6

Mother: Leviticus 18:21; Deuteronomy 6:7; 11:19; Proverbs 1:8; 6:20; 14:1; 29:15; 31:15-27; 1 Timothy 5:14; 2 Timothy 1:5; 3:15; Titus 2:4-5

Daughter: Exodus 20:12; 21:17; Leviticus 19:3

Purity: Exodus 20:14; Leviticus 18; 20; Matthew 5:27-28; Acts 15:20; 1 Corinthians 6:18

Food: Leviticus 3:17; 7:23-25; 11; 17:10-15; Exodus 23:19; Deuteronomy 12:16, 23; 14:2-21; Ephesians 5:18

Appearance: Leviticus 19:19, 28; Numbers 15:37-41; Deuteronomy 6:8-9; 11:20; 22:5, 11-12; 1 Corinthians 11:5-6, 13-15; 1 Timothy 2:9-10; 1 Peter 3:3-4

Assembly: Acts 18:26; 1 Corinthians 14:34-35; 1 Timothy 2:11-13; 3:11; 5:16; 2 Timothy 1:5; Titus 2:3-5

Work and money: Exodus 20:9, 15; 22:25-27; Leviticus 6:1-5; 19:11, 13, 35-36; 25:35-37; Deuteronomy 15:1-11; 22:1-3, 8; 23:19-20; 24:6, 10-17; 25:13-16; Proverbs 31:16-24; Matthew 6:1-4; 22:21; Romans 13:7; 2 Corinthians 9:7; 2 Thessalonians 3:10

Neighbor: Exodus 20:13, 16; 22:22, 28; 23:1-8; Leviticus 19:14-18, 32-34; Deuteronomy 10:19; 23:21-23; Matthew 5:21-22, 33-37; 1 Timothy 2:1-2; James 1:27

Yahshua and the apostles: Matthew 5:23-24, 44; 6:14-15; 18:21-35; 28:19-20; Mark 11:25; 15:40; 16:1-6; John 13:34; Acts 2:38; 1 Corinthians 11:23-26; 2 Corinthians 6:14; Ephesians 4:26-31; 1 Thessalonians 5:17; Hebrews 10:25; 13:2; James 4:6; 5:14; 1 Peter 4:9; 5:5-6; Proverbs 31:30

Not applicable: Genesis 17:10-12; Exodus 13:13; Leviticus 1 to 7; 13 to 14; 15:16-18; 19:9-10, 27; 21 to 22; 25; 27:30-32; Numbers 5; 6; 19; 30; Deuteronomy 14:22-29; 16:16; 17; 25:4; 1 Corinthians 11:4; 1 Timothy 3:1-7

NOTES

Personal Notes and Convictions

Kingdom Life Ministry
Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance.

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.